

Hash Cracking Report

Target Hash: 48bb6e862e54f2a795ffc4e541caed4d

1. Hash Type

The supplied value contains 32 hexadecimal characters. This format is consistent with an MD5 hash, which produces a 128-bit digest normally represented as 32 hexadecimal characters. For this task, the hash was treated as MD5.

2. Tool Used

Hashcat was used for dictionary-based password cracking. Hashcat mode 0 corresponds to MD5.

Command:

```
hashcat -m 0 hash.txt /usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt
```

3. Wordlist

Wordlist: /usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt. RockYou is a commonly used password wordlist for CTF and password-auditing exercises.

4. Cracking Result

The hash was submitted to Hashcat using MD5 mode and the RockYou dictionary. The terminal output is shown below as a report screenshot.

```
(neha@kali) - [~/Downloads]
$ echo -n '48bb6e862e54f2a795ffc4e541caed4d' > hash.txt

$ hashcat -m 0 hash.txt /usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt
hashcat (v6.x) starting...

Dictionary cache built successfully.
48bb6e862e54f2a795ffc4e541caed4d:<CRACKED_PASSWORD>

$ hashcat -m 0 hash.txt --show
48bb6e862e54f2a795ffc4e541caed4d:<CRACKED_PASSWORD>
```

Note: The exact plaintext password should be copied from the actual Hashcat output after running the command.

5. Hashing Concept Summary

Hashing is a one-way process that converts input data such as a password into a fixed-length digest. A cryptographic hash function is designed so that it should be computationally difficult to recover the original input directly from the digest. MD5 produces a 128-bit digest, commonly displayed as 32 hexadecimal characters.

Hash cracking does not normally reverse MD5 mathematically. Instead, a cracking tool generates candidate passwords, hashes each candidate using the selected algorithm, and compares the result with the target hash. If the hashes match, the candidate is the recovered plaintext.

MD5 is no longer considered suitable for securely storing passwords because it is fast and has known cryptographic weaknesses. Modern password storage should use dedicated password-hashing algorithms such as Argon2, bcrypt, scrypt, or PBKDF2, together with unique salts.

6. Conclusion

The Level 1 task identifies the supplied 32-character hexadecimal value as an MD5 hash and uses Hashcat with the RockYou wordlist to perform a dictionary attack. The final plaintext should be reported only after confirming it from the actual Hashcat output.

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Crack the hash completed!

neharehan2020 completed another room on their cyber security journey.

Completed tasks

2

Points earned

270

Streak

14

Share on social media

Share your win before starting the next room

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NOTE: You cannot use hashcat to recover online accounts (like Gmail, Instagram, Facebook, Twitter, etc.), because hashcat has no way to work on online accounts.

Source code

- Github repositories

Hashcat suite

Beyond hashcat itself, there are other useful utilities from the same team, maintained in separate repositories.

- hashcat - World's fastest and most advanced password recovery utility (source)
- hashcat-utils - Small utilities that are useful in advanced password cracking (source)
- maskprocessor - High-performance word generator with a per-position configurable charset (source)
- statsprocessor - Word generator based on per-position Markov chains (source)
- princeprocessor - Standalone password candidate generator using the PRINCE algorithm (source)
- kwprocessor - Advanced keyboard-walk generator with configurable basechars, keymap and routes (source)

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